TOOL 06

HR Tool

Leave, sick days and letters handled with two buttons

What it does

- Gives every employee their own page: days off left, days taken, sick days, salary for each month and their documents.
- Shows a calendar with all public holidays, so people plan time off without asking.
- Lets people ask for days off and log sick days in a few taps.
- Sends the HR lead a chat message with two buttons: "Approve" or "Deny." The employee hears back right away.
- Makes an employment letter as a signed and stamped PDF the moment HR taps "Approve."
- Asks for a doctor's note when someone is sick for more than two days, and keeps every file in one place with a simple dashboard.

Why it's built this way

With two employees, a notebook works. With 30, the HR lead spends all day answering "How many days do I have left?"

So this tool is "stupid simple" on purpose. Here is what we left out and why:

- **No HR app for the boss to learn.** Requests arrive in a chat app the HR lead already uses. They press a button. That's the whole job.
- **No forms to print.** Letters are made from a template with the person's details filled in, then signed and stamped automatically.
- **No guessing on balances.** The tool counts working days and skips weekends and public holidays. Nobody does maths by hand.
- **One rule at a time.** It starts with one clear rule: more than two sick days needs a doctor's note. You add rules only when you need them.

What you need

- **A small database** for staff, requests and documents. Supabase free plan, or about $25 a month.
- **A place to host the app.** Vercel, free or about $20 a month.
- **A Telegram bot** (or another chat app with buttons) for Approve / Deny messages. Telegram bots are free.

- **File storage** for doctor's notes and letters. Supabase storage, included at small sizes.
- **A PDF template** with your letterhead, plus a scan of your signature and stamp.
- **An AI helper to build it.** Claude Code, Cursor or ChatGPT. About $20 a month.

Rough total: **$0 to $65 a month** for a team of up to 100 people.

Build it step by step

Paste these one at a time. Test each step with two fake employees.

1. Start the project.

```
I'm not a programmer. Help me build a simple HR tool with Next.js and
Supabase, and explain each step in plain words. Create tables for:
employees (name, email, job title, start date, yearly leave days, monthly
salary), leave requests (type, start, end, days, status, note file),
public holidays (date, name), and document requests (type, status, file).
```

1. Count days the right way.

```
Write one function that counts working days between two dates. Skip
weekends and any date in the public holidays table. Then work out each
employee's days left this year: yearly days minus approved days. Add a few
tests with tricky dates, like a request that crosses a public holiday.
```

1. Build the employee page.

```
Make a "My Hub" page for the logged-in employee. Show three cards: days
left, days taken, and pending. Below, show a month calendar with public
holidays marked, a list of their requests with status, and a small table of
salary by month. It must look good on a phone.
```

1. Let people ask for time off and log sick days.

```
Add two forms on My Hub. "Request time off": type, from, to, reason. Save it
as "pending". "Log sick leave": from, to, note. If the sick days are more
than 2 working days, show a file upload for a doctor's note and don't allow
saving without it. Sick leave is saved as approved right away.
```

1. Send requests to the HR lead in a chat.

```
Create a Telegram bot and connect it with a webhook. When someone requests
time off, post a message in the HR group: name, dates, number of days, days
left after this, and two buttons, "Approve" and "Deny". Only people marked
as HR in the database may press them. Keep the bot token out of the code.
```

1. Handle the button press.

```
When HR presses Approve or Deny, update the request status, edit the chat
message to show who decided and when, remove the buttons, and send the
employee a private message with the result. Make sure a second tap can't
decide the same request twice.
```

1. Make signed employment letters.

```
Add "Request employment letter" on My Hub, with an optional "addressed to"
field. It posts to the HR chat with Approve / Deny. On Approve, create a PDF
on our letterhead with the employee's name, job title, start date and salary,
add our signature and stamp images, save it, and send it to the employee in
the chat and by email.
```

1. One place for everything.

```
Make an HR dashboard (HR only) with tabs: Team (everyone with days left),
Leave (all requests and a team calendar), Documents (company policies plus
every letter request, with Approve / Deny buttons), and Public holidays
(add or remove dates for the year).
```

Make it yours

- **Your country's rules:** set yearly leave days, sick pay levels and carry-over limits to match your local labour law.
- **Backup approver:** if the HR lead is on leave, send requests to a second person.
- **Policy sign-off:** upload the handbook and ask everyone to sign that they read it.
- **Payslips:** let people download a payslip for any month HR has checked.

Watch out for

- **Salaries and medical notes are private.** Only the employee and HR should see them. Ask the AI to check who can read each table, and test it by logging in as a normal employee.

- **Check your local labour law.** Leave days, sick pay and notice rules differ by country. The tool should follow the law, not guess it.
- **Signed letters are official.** Only one or two people should be able to approve them, and every letter should be saved. Check your local rules on electronic signatures and company stamps before relying on them. This is not legal advice.
- **Update public holidays every year.** Some holiday dates move each year. Put a reminder in your calendar to load next year's dates.
- **Keep the bot token secret.** Store it as a secret setting, never in the code.